ZeitGeist
Moonlit Revelry



BEYOND WORDS

Rulebook 2026

INTRODUCTION

Beyond Words is an instrumental solo and duet competition that celebrates music as a language beyond speech. It is a platform where melodies express emotions, stories, and connections that words cannot capture. From classical to contemporary and fusion styles, participants are invited to let their instruments speak and create moments that resonate with the soul.

GENERAL RULES

A standard 5-piece drum kit, including two crashes, one ride, one hi-hat, and a double pedal, will be provided. Teams are required to bring any additional instruments they wish to use. Modifications to the stage setup are permitted; however, teams must restore it to its original configuration within the allocated time limit. Any damage caused to the provided equipment may lead to disqualification in that event and/or financial penalties at the discretion of the Organizing Committee.

While a team leaves the stage, one representative from the next performing team must verify the stage setup and technical requirements before their slot begins. This pre-performance check will not be included in the event's time limit.

Judges will evaluate performances from 'AMPS ON' to 'AMPS OFF', prompted by the participants to indicate the start and end of their performance, distinguishing it from setup time. Pieces performed before prompting 'AMPS ON' will not be judged.

Participants must report at least 30 minutes before the start of the competition to manage any changes in the provided slots.

In case of any mistake from the Organizing Committee such as equipment failure, another soundcheck slot can be provided at the discretion of the Organizing Committee.

Rules

- Number of participants from a team: 1 - 2 members
- Duration: Maximum of 10 minutes for performance and setup (+5 minutes in case of left-handed drummer).
- Prerecorded tracks are not allowed
- DAW looping is allowed

Penalties for extension

- 10:00 to 10:30 = 5 score Points deducted
- 10:30 to 11:00 = 10 score Points deducted
- 11:00 to 11:30 = 15 score Points deducted
- 11:30 = Performance will be stopped & 25 points deduction

REGISTRATION RULES

- This is an online individual event under Zeitgeist'26.
- Students from all institutions are eligible to participate.
- Only one entry per participant is allowed
- Participants Register through Unstop

JUDGING CRITERIA

- Song Selection
- Creativity
- Synchronization
- Technical Brilliance / Individual skill
- Arrangement

PRIZES WORTH 10K

- Winner - Exciting prizes + Certificates
- First Runner Up - Exciting prizes + Certificates

Participation certificates will be provided to all participants with valid submissions.

PARTICIPATION FEES:

* A registration fee of ₹200 per participant is required
* Registration will be confirmed only after successful payment of the fee.
* The participation fee is non-refundable under any circumstances.

CONTACTS

For any queries, feel free to contact:

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